

THE CHURCH OF

*Our Lady of Lourdes**Serving the Parishes of Steelstown & Culmore**Sunday 27th September 2026**26th Sunday in Ordinary Time (A)***MASS TIMES****SUNDAYS**

Vigil: 6.30pm
Sunday: 09.00am;
 11.00am;
 12.15pm

WEEKDAYS

Monday – Friday: 7.45am
Monday: 7.00pm
Tuesday – Saturday: 10.00am

CONFESSIONS**WEEKEND**

Saturday: After 10am Mass;
 5.45pm – 6.25pm
Sunday: 10.30am – 10.50am

WEEKDAYS

Monday: 6.30pm – 6.55pm
Tuesday: 8.10am – 8.30am
Thursday: 9.30am – 09.50am

DEVOTIONS**EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION**

Thursday: 08.00 – 09.55am
 10.30am – 12 noon

ROSARY

Before 10am Mass

DIVINE MERCY CHAPLET

After 10am Mass

“A man had two sons. He went and said to the first, “My boy, you go and work in the vineyard today.” He answered, “I will not go,” but afterwards thought better of it and went. The man then went and said the same thing to the second who answered, “Certainly, sir,” but did not go. Which of the two did the father’s will?”
 (Matthew 21:28-31)

This parable has an uncomfortable directness for us. The second son — the one who says "Certainly, sir" — is not an atheist or an indifferent secularist. He is the person who attends Mass every Sunday, knows the responses, perhaps serves on the parish council, and yet has kept one corner of his life deliberately untouched by the Gospel: an unreconciled relationship, a business practice he knows is unjust, a habitual sin he has never seriously resolved to abandon. The parable calls the listener to honest self-examination before God: is my faith a matter of words and appearances, or has it actually reshaped my choices? In a culture saturated with performative religiosity — social media piety, virtue signalling, even spiritual aesthetics — Jesus' question cuts through every layer of presentation to the point that matters: ‘did you go?’ Equally, the first son offers genuine hope to those who feel they have said "no" to God for years — through long stretches of lapsed practice, moral failure, or outright rejection of faith. The parable makes clear that the Father still calls, that the vineyard still needs workers, and that a repentance that actually moves the feet is worth more in God's sight than a lifetime of polished words that never translate into action.

Adapted from ‘A Commentary on Matthew 21’ by SacredTextsGuide.com

NEW PETITIONS BOX – if you would like to write out a petition for someone who is sick, there’s a new petitions box under the image of ‘Our Lady of Perpetual Help’. Intentions will be remembered at the Rosary during the week and at Mass on Saturday mornings. Sincere thanks to Michael for making the box!

PARISH OFFICE

Wednesday – Friday: 9am – 3pm

028 7135 1718

steelstown@derrydiocese.org / culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST

Rev. Declan McGeehan P.P./Adm.
declan.mcgeehan@derrydiocese.org

Urgent sick calls: 073 5238 7817

VOCATIONS TO THE PRIESTHOOD – Are you 18 years or older and thinking about serving the Church as a priest of the Diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon talk with time for prayer, discussion, questions & answers in Derry City on Sunday 11th October. For further details, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan at: pgoh2111@gmail.com

MASS INTENTIONS –In accordance with Canon Law, all Masses in this Parish are offered for a single donor's intentions except the Masses on Saturdays at 6.30pm and Mondays at 7pm – these Masses may be “shared Masses”, i.e. for the intentions of multiple donors. If you would like a Mass offered for your intentions, please contact the Parish Office.

MINISTRY TO THE SICK – Would you be willing to bring Holy Communion to the sick in their own homes or in care centres in our parishes? If so, please contact the Parish Office for further information.

DOING OUR BIT FOR NATURE AT OUR LADY OF LOURDES Join us for this year's *Meitheal* on Saturday 3rd October, at 11am, to plant Spring bulbs, maintain the rewilding area at the back of the Church, and to litter pick. For more information, contact the Parish Eco Group: 07711900420 / 07704885894

ANNUAL SAFEGUARDING MASS – Bishop Michael Router invites everyone involved in Safeguarding to the Annual Safeguarding Mass on Friday 2nd October at 7.30pm in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry. The Safeguarding Mass will be offered for all who have suffered the pain of abuse and for those who continue to work and support ongoing safeguarding practices across our diocese.

THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word*' series of 4 Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome.

ACCORD COUPLE COUNSELLING – Our couples counselling specialists provide in-person and online services to individuals and couples dealing with relationship challenges. For further information, or to make an appointment, please contact us on: Tel: (028)71362475; email: derry@accordni.com; or visit: www.accordni.com

'FIND THE ABLE BEYOND THE LABEL' – is a free Information Evening for parents and carers of children and young people with learning challenges, with Neurodevelopmental Practitioner Anne-Marie O'Kane, at Culmore Community Hub on Wednesday 30th September, 7:30 pm- 8:30pm. Tea and coffee provided.



800th ANNIVERSARY OF THE TRANSITUS OF SAINT FRANCIS OF ASSISI

Saint Francis of Assisi died on the evening of 3rd October 1226, and, ever since, Franciscans worldwide have observed this day by recalling the last moments of his life. It is told that, as death approached, one of his brothers asked him what kind of death he would prefer, quick and unexpected or prolonged and painful. St. Francis answered: “*Brother, I want whatever death God wants for me.*”

What faith, what love there is in that answer! It reveals St. Francis' total surrender to the will of the “most high, all-powerful, all good Lord.” It echoes the words of Jesus in the Garden of Gethsemane, “Father, not my will, but yours be done,” and on the cross, “Father, into your hands I commend my spirit.”

In his ‘Canticle of the Creatures’, Francis praises God through His creatures – even death. “(Laudato Si’ ...) *Praised be you, my Lord, through our Sister, Bodily Death, from whom no one living can escape. Woe to those who die in mortal sin! Blessed are those whom she will find in Your most holy will, for the second death will do them no harm! Praise and bless my Lord, and give Him thanks, and serve Him humbly, but grandly!*”

‘Transitus: St. Francis Embraces Sister Death’, www.FranciscanMedia.org

Peter Paul Reubens,
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SAFEGUARDING NOTICE – We are committed to ensuring the safety and well-being of everyone in our parishes. If you have any concerns regarding the safeguarding of children or adults in need of protection within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person, on 07596 500793; or email: marie.okane@derrydiocese.org